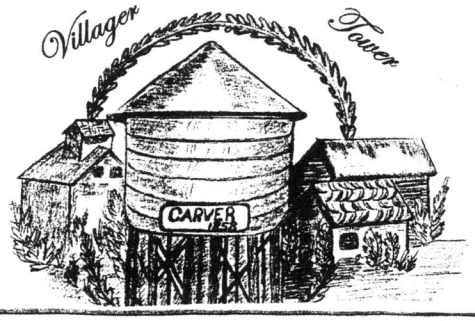
Volume XXIV
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Strategic Planning Work Session

The council held a strategic planning work session discussing the use of a financial plan as a tool to identify baseline needs for the next ten years and to aid in providing the framework for analyzing impacts of policy decisions. This plan could be used to keep the tax rate at or below the currently levels, to use debt so that the growth would pay for itself and help to build and maintain fund balances. Suggestion was submitted that the city get "rated" as bonded debt interested charges would be lower.

The city planner and the attorney discussed with the council the developer's issues and infrastructure needs requiring their attention as these developments continue.

The council was also told that the SW Transportation is seeking support for efforts to get Highway #212 widened by the state. Council consensus was that this issue should be discussed at the council meeting and a resolution reviewed at that time.

Municipal Utilities

The Public Utilities Supervisor was asked about the progress of removing septic tanks. Question was asked process of determining tank removal. The council discussed chlorine issues.
The mayor asked when the city could expect construction to begin on the water tower. The engineer stated that the expected date was the fall of 2006.

Chaska Youth Center

The council reviewed the monetary donation request. The request had been forwarded to the Park and Recreation Board for consideration. A fund from the past allocated for 'youth activities' was decided to be used for partial donation to the Chaska Youth Center request. The city would donate the balance. The council discussed their funds and recommendations. Decision was made by motion and was carried with all ayes to donate money to the Community Youth Center in Chaska and discuss budgeting more money in the following year for the center.

Don't walk in front of me,
I may not follow.
Don't walk behind me,
I may not lead.
Just walk beside me and be my friend.

City Insurance Renewal

The city's insurance agent discussed and reviewed renewal of city insurance. There were changes in the policy for the upcoming year. The agent also explained that the League of MN Cities had implemented a new ruling regarding flood insurance. Costs with variable deductibles were discussed. The agent also explained that there was a thirty day waiting period after applying for insurance before it is effective. The administrator pointed out that the city's decision last year was to waive the insurance and it had not been budgeted for again this year. It was the building inspector's opinion that the city hall was out of the flood plain. The FEMA map would be checked. Once councilmember expressed concern regarding the Church-By-The-River because of its historical significance and all of the work that has been done. Motion was made and carried authorizing flood insurance for the Church-By-The-River structure and review the other two city buildings at the following meeting.

The agent and the city discussed tort limits on liability coverage and whether or not the city wanted to waive this limit. The city attorney stated that the State Statute Tort Liability is capped, but the city can waive tort over one million dollars. Motion was made and carried with all ayes to waive the Tort Liability.

The agent also informed the council of the necessity to diagram the open spaces in the city. The MN League needs drawings of the parks and all of the equipment and structures in them. Motion was made and carried with all ayes directing the staff to conduct an inventory of all of the open space areas.

The council discussed insurance with the agent and determination was made that the city hall was not in the 500 year flood plain area. However, the utility building was inclusive in the flood plain area. Decision was made that the utility building would not be insured for flood damage if that event were to occur. Motion was made and carried with all ayes authorizing payment of the renewal premium with the League of MN Cities for excess liability insurance. The Public Works and Municipal Utilities departments were conducting the inventory of hydrants and park equipment. Motion was made and carried with all ayes to insure hydrants at an additional premium. Upon completion of the inventory of park equipment, the administrator was directed to review this inventory and agent to decide coverage premium limits.

LyleWood Glen

The Planning Commission held a Public Hearing to review the request to amend the Conditional Use Permit for the Lylewood Glen Town Homes. The Planning Commission recommended approval of the request to amend the Conditional Use Permit.

The city planner told the council that the Heritage Development is requesting an amendment to their existing Conditional Use Permit to change the architectural elevations of town homes for the remaining blocks to be built within the subdivision. The proposal primarily affects the two-story end units. Market conditions prompted this change. Motion was made and carried with all ayes adopting the resolution amending the Conditional Use Permit for the town homes in the Heritage Development. Motion was made and carried adopting the resolution amending resolution approving the final plat for the development of LyleWood Glen.

Ms4 General Permit

The council held a Public Hearing on the Storm Water Pollution Prevention Plan. The engineering firm representative gave a presentation for the annual meeting required by the state. The city has been operating under an NPDES Phase II General Storm Water permit from the MN Pollution Control Agency since 2003. The permit required the city to prepare and submit a Storm Water Pollution Prevention Program to the MPCA. Then each year the city is required to conduct a storm water public meeting to educate the public and allow interested citizens an opportunity to comment on the existing prevention program and an update on the progress to reaching the measurable goals. This annual report is due to the MPCA. Compliance costs were inquired about. The engineering firm representative inspects the program once a year at his cost, but the public works superintendent ensures that the plan is being adhered to. The superintendent estimated approximately fifteen percent of his time is spent on the NPDES requirements. Resident inquired about pollution coming down the river and could it be stopped. The response was that the pollution was mainly urban runoff and a lot was being done to stop this. Another asked about dumping into the river. This was also addressed.

Did You Know...

...that in the late 1870's by horse and wagon Chaska baker, Gottleib Eder made weekly deliveries of rye bread to Carver homes and stores. Rye bread was then an important food staple.

Spring Creek Woods

The Planning Commission held a Public Hearing on the preliminary plat request for Spring Creek Woods development. Request had been made to rezone the property, Planned Residential District and approval of the preliminary plat. They are seeking to develop approximately seventeen and a half acres of property south of the grove at Spring Creek. Explanation was also given that access is required through another parcel to the north being developed at the present time. The city is not allowed to give authorization for construction in this development until the other developer has completed the street and the utility extensions to said property. Another existing condition is also an existing easement for an alternate septic site location for property to the south. Additionally another property owner must also agree to release the easement. The issue is being discussed with affected properties and the county. It was the planner's opinion that approvals could be sought regardless. An overview was presented to the Planning Commission for the proposed development consisting of twenty single family lots.

Commissioners discussed and questioned storm water ponds and designs. This pond was for emergency overflow purposes. These types of ponds have been constructed at Carver Creek without having any issues. Deterioration of the ponds was questioned. It was stated that these pond designs are used all around the states. Another question was asked about the house pad compared to the high water level of the pond. They reviewed the site plan and the grading plan. House pad locations and ponds elevations were again reviewed.

The next issue questioned concerned construction of decks. Statement was made that there should not be any issues with deck construction on any of the sites and set back requirements were reviewed. The engineer presented an overview of the 100 year high water mark. A discussion was held regarding the differences between set backs and easements.

The commissioners reviewed and discussed the bluff mitigation plan. The pond is outside the pond in the easement. Question was asked about the normal high water level mark. Plants were discussed and if they were on the slope along the east side and a more detailed plan could be submitted with the final plat application. The commission was told that there would be six to ten different varying types of plantings and different colors. The plantings would be native prairie plants and wild flowers.

The storm sewer was reviewed. The commissioners were told that the development would share storm sewer with the adjacent development. Ponding was reviewed and compliance with necessary requests was being worked on with the city engineering firm. Work is also being conducted on resolution of the septic system. Types of retaining walls were questioned. The Planning Commission recommended approval of rezoning contingent on the septic system issue being resolved and subject to all conditions as recommended by the city planner.

Third Street Improvements

The council discussed Third Street Improvements proposed and what the project would entail. The engineer explained that there were springs existing along Third Street and west of Jorgenson. The Public Works Department had tried several different measures over the years to address this problem but to no avail. This past winter these springs continued to run and cause serious icing issues on County Road #40. The least expensive option was placement of drain tile to pick up the spring and route it to Spring Creek. Four quotes had been obtained. Question was asked if the road would be required to be closed. The engineer stated that rerouting of traffic would be required. The public works superintendent explained that a five foot wide cut for about six hundred feet would be required and the project should be completed in a couple of days. The engineer explained that this project was considered maintenance. Recommendation was submitted to authorize the project and accept the low bid. Motion was made carried authorizeing proceeding with the project and accept the low bid.

Did You Know...

...that in May 1871 Christian Goltz was building a two-story frame building on Broadway in Carver.

River Bluff Estates

The Planning Commission reviewed the request for an amendment to RiverBluff Estates development to the Conditional Use Permit. The Heritage Preservation Commission had also reviewed the requested changes. Grading changes were also planned so that the units could be built as walkout basement units. Question was asked if these changes affected the existing retaining wall. The developer stated that changes were made to accommodate the style changes and an additional retaining wall was then necessary.

The commission discussed grading changes, retaining walls, design of retaining wall, fences and the necessity to enhance the design of the wall/fences. It is necessary to achieve the visual accommodations with the City of Carver, the historical aspect and neighboring surroundings utilizing aesthetics such as the planting of varieties of plants, which would climb down and up the retaining wall. Fencing types were questioned. It was the city planner's opinion that the Heritage Preservation Commission did not have issues with the fencing and suggested submittal of amendment request to be presented to the city council.

Question was asked about the height of the unit changing with grading changes. The developer explained that the tuck-under garages had been removed from the plans, therefore it may be possible that the elevations may be slightly lower than originally planned. Height differences were discussed. The roof pitch had not been changed. Safety regarding the retaining wall was an issue and concern with commissioner and who would be liable if there were an accident. The developer responded that the Home Owners Association would be liable. One commissioner expressed disapproval of the entire development. The Planning Commission recommended approval of the amended Conditional Use Permit with stipulations.

The developer requested an amendment to the existing Conditional Use Permit to change the architectural elevations of the town homes. If the town home architecture were approved, then approval of grading would also require changes. The developer proposes to alter the grading surrounding the units on the west of the private road converting these units to slab on grade rather then tucked into the hillside. The result is additional retaining walls constructed between the back of these units and the homes on top of the hill. The developer was asked to return to the council with the landscape plans and drawings of the proposed retaining wall. A council member requested approval of these plans be done by resolution outlining the requirements.

Carver Youth Baseball/Softball Association

Submitted by Jane Thon:

The softball/baseball season is coming to an end. Between T-Ball, Coach Pitch and Softball we had over 170 youths playing. What a tribute to our community to have that involvement.

I would like to thank everyone that has contributed to our programs. This can only happen with the involvement of parents, past players, umpire's parental involvement, our Lions and the Park and Recreation Department and the City of Carver as we all work together to offer these programs.

The girl's softball tournament will be at the Pioneer Fields in Chaska on July 15th and 16th as follows: Girls 2nd and 3rd grade will have two games on Friday Night the 14th followed by a watermelon feed and trophies presented. The balance of our teams will play on Saturday and Sunday. All Championship games will start around 3 PM on Sunday.

As we move forward with our programs, the Carver Youth Baseball/ Softball Association will be needing our involvement in programs and helping coordinate them. Please watch for more information to come out in the fall newsletters.
Thanks again to all – Jane C Thon

Did You Know...

....that Axel Jorgenson, the founder of Carver in 1852, later ran a jewelry shop in Shakopee. By 1871 he had moved the jewelry operation to Chaska, before moving it to Waconia in 1875.

PERSISTENCE

"Nothing in the World can take the place of Persistence.
Talent will not; Nothing is more common than unsuccessful men with talent.
Genius will not; unrewarded genius is almost a proverb.
Education will not; the world is full of educated derelicts.
Persistence and determination alone are omnipotent."
- Calvin Coolidge -

SOME PEOPLE

Some people come into our lives and quickly go.
Some people move our souls to dance.
They awaken us to a new understanding with the passing whisper of their wisdom.
Some people make the sky more beautiful to gaze upon.
They stay in our lives for awhile, leave foot prints in our hearts, and we are never, ever the same.

Fire Department

The Fire Chief reported to the council that three new members will be joining the department. The council was invited to the fire department's Life Link Training scheduled for July 17th at the fire station at 7 PM. Area departments have also been invited, along with a helicopter scheduled to make an appearance for the training.

August training plans are for Advanced Auto Extrication. The chief informed the city of the necessity to upgrade their tools. The Lions and Legion are being solicited for contributions. The city needs to be kept updated the chief was told. The Fire Equipment Committee's quarterly meeting requires scheduling, also.

The Fire Chief also discussed training for them and the staff for the National Incident Management System (NIMS). The training is about twenty four hours. The chief upon completion of training will be certified and qualified to administer this training. He also volunteered to conduct this training for the staff and council over a couple of Saturdays. This program is a direct result of '911' and all cities are now mandated to have an Emergency Management Director (position held by the Fire Chief as directed by the city ordinance), therefore, council and city staff is required to attain various levels of training the event of a disaster occurring.

Forner Improvements

The city council held a Public Hearing regarding the Forner Lane Improvements. A slide presentation and reviewal of the project was conducted by the city engineer. Estimated assessments were discussed. One property owner requested hook up to the city utilities presently. The engineer explained the necessity to construct a grinder lift station since the gravity system would not work in the area. The requirement would establish a privately owned lift station. Increased costs were questioned. The Mt Hope Improvement project and increased construction costs were the reasons for changes in estimates. Street lighting was not included in the project because this item would raise costs even higher. State purchased property maintenance was talked about. An additional item requiring discussion include utilities credit. Motion was made and carried with all ayes adopting the resolution ordering improvements and preparation of plans for the Forner Lane Utility Improvements.

State of the City Address

The council discussed the State of the City Address that the mayor presented to the Chamber of Commerce and his presentation to the council. Motion was made and carried with all ayes directing the mayor to present his State of the City Address prior to the July 10th council meeting. The video cameraman was requested to tape the event.

Did You Know...

...that on 12th of May 1887 the *Weekly Valley Herald* advertised that "all persons having colts to be castrated can leave orders for the same with the following persons", which included Louis Larson in Carver.

City Engineer

The city engineer reviewed additional costs relating to engineering studies being conducted in the city. The council was informed of additional costs incurred involving the Water Distribution Study, the Comprehensive Sanitary Sewer Study and Surface Water Management Plan. It was explained that the city had been working on their Comprehensive Plan and the Southwest Alternate Urban Area Review had grown along with another developer involved in the area. The land use plan requires changing in the northwest area of the Alternate Urban Area Review study. When the land use changes then the models also require adjustments to coincide with the Comprehensive Plan.

Question was asked about the completion of the three studies being completed during the summer of 2006. The engineer stated that the Public Hearings would be held over the summer. Authorizing the completion of these studies was discussed. Motion was made and carried with all ayes approving the engineering firm to continue with the studies and schedule of hours dedicated to the project to be presented to the council for review.

TENTATIVE AGENDA

City of Carver Council
Monday Evening 6:30 PM

1) Call to Order
2) Pledge of Allegiance
3) Approve Agenda
4) Petitions and Requests
5) Consent Agenda
6) Municipal Utilities Report
7) Building Inspector Report
8) City Planner Report
9) City Engineer Report
10) City Attorney Report
11) Administrator Report
12) Liaison Reports
13) Other Business
14) Adjourn



Disclaimer

The 'unapproved' minutes of the council and the township have been referenced for the purposes of reporting news in the "*Villager Tower*" and creating the contents of this newsletter for the purpose of informing residents in the City of Carver and the townships surrounding the city.

Women's Business Group

The Women's Business Group will be meeting on Tuesday, July 11th at noon in the Church-By-The-River for a pot-luck. Anyone interested in attending is welcome to attend. The business group's mission is: "To create a sense of community by promoting business, growth and community participation in the historic district of Carver while maintaining the historic integrity and charm of our small river town."

City of Carver DownTown Task Force

The City of Carver is seeking people to join a Task Force to come up with ideas in order to keep the historic downtown vital and active as the little city grows. Requirements are ideas, enthusiasm and spirit to contribute to the 'think tank' group. If you are interested, contact the administrator and sign up for an upcoming meeting to be announced. By the way, need not be a city resident to participate. Anyone interested in preserving the endangered village is asked to come and participate.

Mustard Moon

News Flash! Mustard Moon is coming back to Carver! Jane Hall has been in Chaska for the past three years and now she's coming back to our quaint 'lil' Carver! Welcome Back! She will be moving into the Potted Fig space. She will open for business in September. So with this announcement, please be sure to stop in and 'welcome her back'!

Carver Fire Department Highlights and Community Calendar

July 2006

July 4th - 4th of July/Independence Day
Happy Anniversary John – Sandy!
July 5th - Lion's Meeting
Happy Birthday Doug!
July 6th - Drill Night – 6:30 PM
July 7th through 9th – Softball Tournaments
July 9th - Happy Birthday DONNA!
July 10th - Council Meeting
Dahlgren Township Board Meeting
July 11th - Women's Business Group
July 12th - SteamBoat Days Meeting
Happy Birthday Maria!
July 13th - Happy Birthday David!
July 14th - Happy Birthday Paul!
Happy Birthday Barb!
Belle Plaine Barbeque Days
July 15th - Happy Birthday Tony!
Happy Birthday Krissy!
July 17th - Drill Night – 6:30 PM
Park and Recreation Board Meeting
July 18th - Heritage Preservation Commission Meeting
July 22nd - Happy Birthday Becky!
July 23rd - Happy Anniversary Doug and Aletta!
July 24th - Happy Anniversary John!
Council Meeting
Comprehensive Plan Work Group Meeting
July 25th - Planning Commission Meeting
Happy Birthday Janelle!
July 26th - Happy Birthday Bonnie!
July 26th through July 30th - Scott County Fair
July 27th - Fire Department Meeting Night
July 28th - Happy Birthday Diane!

A little courage can conquer even the biggest fears.

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